

Twin Toddler Chaos Survival — Action Checklist

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SET UP SAFE CONTAINMENT

- ☐ **Set Up Safe Containment:** Designate 1-2 baby-gated areas in your home as containment zones that are free of hard corners, choking hazards, and injury risks. This gives you a safe place to move both children during simultaneous tantrums without locking them in.
- ☐ **Set Up Safe Containment:** Clear your containment zones of furniture with hard corners, small choking objects, and anything that could cause injury during a fall. Toddlers lose control during tantrums and safety must come first.
- ☐ **Set Up Safe Containment:** Place yourself between two fighting toddlers with open hands and a low voice when separation is needed. Do not grab, do not yell, do not try to explain—just separate them physically and wait.
- ☐ **Set Up Safe Containment:** Use your body as a barrier to break twin escalation loops when one child's dysregulation feeds the other's. Breaking physical proximity stops the feedback cycle that makes conflicts worse.

PREVENT SECOND CHAOS

- ☐ **Prevent Second Chaos:** When one child escalates but the other remains calm, rescue the calm child first by directing their attention to a preferred activity immediately. Preventing the second emergency is your priority.
- ☐ **Prevent Second Chaos:** Address the physical needs of a dysregulated child first—hunger, tiredness, overstimulation, or teething discomfort—before attempting any behavioral intervention or emotional coaching.
- ☐ **Prevent Second Chaos:** Give the calm child a favorite toy, book, or screen activity right away to prevent their mood from shifting while you handle their sibling. Association with parental attention can trigger second escalations.
- ☐ **Prevent Second Chaos:** When both children have escalated, move them to your containment zone and sit outside the gate to wait. Do not attempt to mediate or negotiate—most tantrums peak within 5-8 minutes.

SPLIT PARENTING DUTIES

- ☐ **Split Parenting Duties:** Establish explicit night shift boundaries with your partner, assigning each parent a clear handoff time for overnight wake-ups so both adults get at least one uninterrupted sleep block.
 - ☐ **Split Parenting Duties:** Schedule daytime coverage in blocks of no more than 6 consecutive hours during peak toddler chaos so neither parent is on duty long enough to burn out.
 - ☐ **Split Parenting Duties:** Match each parent to the twin whose temperament aligns with their strengths, such as assigning the more adaptable parent to handle the sensory-seeking child during high-stimulation times.
 - ☐ **Split Parenting Duties:** Set up two identical play stations on opposite sides of the same room so each twin has their own space and materials, eliminating competition over single objects that fuels daily conflict.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.